

Town Planning in Harappan Civilization

Town Planning in Harappan Civilization (Little Detail + Experience)

Little Detail:

- The Harappan cities (like Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa) were among the earliest in the world with a planned urban layout.
- The city was divided into two parts:
 1. Citadel (Western side): Built on a raised platform with fortified walls. It housed important buildings such as granaries, the Great Bath, and possibly religious or administrative centers.
 2. Lower Town (Eastern side): Larger and more spacious, where the general population lived.
- Cities were laid out in a grid pattern streets intersected at right angles, forming rectangular blocks.
- They used kiln-fired bricks for buildings, roads, and drains showing high craftsmanship.
- Advanced drainage system: Covered brick drains ran along the streets, connected to individual houses.
- Towns were built on raised platforms to protect from seasonal floods of the Indus River.

Experience: Imagine Walking Through a Harappan City

As you walk through the wide, straight streets of Mohenjo-Daro, you notice how clean and organized everything feels. Each house has a similar design thick brick walls, flat roofs, a central open courtyard, and no windows facing the main road. Side windows allow fresh air to circulate.

You pass by the Citadel, standing tall and sturdy on its high brick platform. From there, you spot the Great Bath a large rectangular tank made of tightly fitted bricks, once filled with water for rituals.

Around it are small rooms and a staircase on each end.

The Lower Town spreads out in front of you homes arranged in neat blocks, all connected by covered drains that run beneath your feet. You feel amazed at how modern and well-thought-out everything is a planned city from over 4,000 years ago!